



Geoffrey Herbert Tigar

1896 - 1917

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	G Tigar Geoffrey Herbert Tigar	JLS memorial CWGC
Date of Birth	July 1896 Haverstock Hill Sept Qtr 1896 Pancras Registration District	Harrow Observer death announcement 1911 census GRO
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	13/10/1917 Near Near Poelcapelle according to Artists' Rifles (see below)	CWGC Artists' Rifles (see below)
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	21	
Marital Status		
Children (if any)		
Occupation prior to Call up	Worked in an accountant's office in the City	Harrow Observer death announcement

Parents	Son of Walter and Mary Agnes Tigar, of 112 Nibthwaite Rd, Harrow in 1917	CWGC
Listed Address(s)	1911 Nibthwaite Rd, Harrow 1901 23 Maitland Park Villas, St Pancras	1911 census 1901 census
Parents /Fathers occupation	Stock and Share Dealer (LSE)	1911 census
Brothers and Sisters There were 3 brothers total who lost their lives in WW1 according to Harrow Observer Geofrey and Howard died in service. We believe the 3 rd brother who died was Laurence but we believe he did not die in battle.	Frederick Joseph Tigar (older), Howard Walter Tigar (older), Laurence Edward Tigar (older), Wilfrid Joseph Tigar (younger), Edith Mary Tigar (younger)	1911 census
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)		
Obituary	See Harrow Observer below	Harrow Observer
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	John Lyon School (plaque)	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11204
	John Lyon School (sundial)	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11318
	Our Lady & St Thomas of Canterbury, Roxborough Park	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/249978
	St John the Baptist, Greenhill, Harrow	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/340819
	Wealdstone Clocktower	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/340688

Military research

JLS WWI RoH	TIGAR G.H.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-war-dead/casualty/827781/tigar,-geoffrey-herbert/
Age	21
DoD	13-Oct-17
Rank	2 Lt
Regiment	Royal Berkshire Regiment 6th Bn
Organisations must have served or have members who served in the Ypres Salient or the Somme in World War One.	TYNE COT MEMORIAL
Location	West-Vlaanderen, Belgium
CWGC in process of uploading image of headstones which will give us his age, hopefully.	* Records from the Douai Society website. This indicates he was not only an Old Lyonian but also a former schoolboy at Douai. Son of Walter and Mary Agnes Tigar, of 112, Nibthwaite Rd., Harrow, Middx. Second Lieutenant Geoffrey Herbert Tigar was killed in action on October 13, 1917, at the age of 21, during the Battle of Passchendaele (the Third Battle of Ypres). He served with the 6th Battalion, Royal Berkshire Regiment. He died in the muddy, heavily shell-torn landscape near Ypres (West-Vlaanderen), Belgium. On the morning of his death, during a major assault across the waterlogged terrain, his unit was moving forward in artillery formation through Sanctuary Wood. His battalion encountered a heavy German artillery barrage and intense machine-gun fire as they attempted to link up with neighboring units (the 17th Manchester Regiment). Because his body was never recovered or could not be identified from the battlefield, he has no known grave.

Story of Sacrifice

Harold and Geoffrey Tigar

The Tigar brothers, Harold Walter and Geoffrey Herbert, were both educated at John Lyon School in Harrow and served during the First World War. Their military careers took different paths, with Harold killed in 1915 at Aubers Ridge and Geoffrey killed two years later during the fighting at Passchendaele.

Harold Walter Tigar (1893 – 1916)

Civilian Life

Harold Walter Tigar was born in Belgium in about 1893 and was the son of Walter and Mary Agnes Tigar of 112 Nibthwaite Road, Harrow. His father was a stock and share dealer on the London Stock Exchange. Harold was an Old Lyonian and also attended the school at Douai. Before the war he studied accountancy and passed his intermediate examination of the Incorporated Society of Accountants.

Military Life and Death

Harold served with the Middlesex Regiment. He held a commission as Lieutenant in the 3rd Battalion but was serving at the front attached to the 2nd Battalion. On 9 May 1915, the 2nd Middlesex took part in the Battle of Aubers Ridge where the Army launched a massive, coordinated assault against entrenched German positions in northern France and Flanders. The 2nd Battalion, Middlesex Regiment formed a key part of the attacking force. As the men climbed over the parapet to advance toward the enemy trenches, they were immediately caught in a murderous, crossfire barrage of German artillery and heavy machine-gun fire. Tigar was killed alongside dozens of his fellow officers and hundreds of his men within the opening hours of the offensive. Because the battlefield was under constant, intense bombardment for months, his remains were never recovered or identified.

Harold was killed in action near Klein Zillebeke in the Ypres Salient at the age of 22. His remains were not recovered or identified, and he is commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial.

Geoffrey Herbert Tigar (1896 – 1916)

Civilian Life

Geoffrey Herbert Tigar was born in Haverstock Hill in July 1896 and was the son of Walter and Mary Agnes Tigar of Nibthwaite Road, Harrow. He was educated at St. Chr tienne's School, Wealdstone, and the Lower School of John Lyon, where he passed the Junior Oxford Examination. He was also known for playing football. Before the war he worked in an accountant's office in the City.

Military Life and Death

Soon after the outbreak of war, Geoffrey left his position and joined the Artists Rifles in March 1915, going to France in August that year. He subsequently received a commission in the 6th Battalion, Royal Berkshire Regiment, in August 1916, becoming a Second Lieutenant.

On October 12, the Allied forces launched the First Battle of Passchendaele. The assault took place in torrential rain, turning the battlefield near Poelcappelle into a deep swamp of liquid mud and shell craters. Over October 12–13, the 6th Battalion, Royal Berkshire Regiment was tasked with holding newly won, precarious positions and enduring intense, retaliatory German artillery bombardments and machine-gun fire. 2nd Lt. Tigar was killed on 13 October near Poelcappelle during these fierce tactical exchanges. He was only 21 years old. Because his body was never recovered or identified from the chaotic battlefield, he has no known grave. He is commemorated on the Panel 105 to 106 of the Tyne Cot Memorial in Belgium.

Three brothers lost during the war years

Research also records a third Tigar brother, Laurence Edward, who died in the final quarter of 1915. However, he is not recorded by the Commonwealth War Graves Commission or Imperial War Museums. It is likely that he was not in the armed services when he died. Sadly not without precedent, even within the context of bereaved families of John Lyon pupils, the First World War brought the deaths of three sons, Harold and Geoffrey in military service and a third son, Laurence. Two further sons survived the war, a younger brother Wilfred died in 1966 age 65 and an older brother Frederick didn't die until 1954.

Photos



Tigar G. (AI enhanced)



Tigar G (Original)

Notes and Clippings

Harrow Observer 26/10/1917

SECOND LIEUT. G. TIGAR.

The sad news has been received, as stated in the OBSERVER last week, that Mr. and Mrs. W. Tigar, of The Den, Nibthwaite-road, Harrow, have lost a third son—Second Lieut. Geoffrey Tigar—since the War. Mr. Tigar was born at Maitland-park, Haverstock Hill, in July, 1896, and consequently spent his 21st birthday in the trenches. He was educated at St. Chrétienne's School, Wealdstone, and the Lower School of John Lyon, where he passed the Junior Oxford Exam. He was well-known in the football field. Soon after war was declared he threw up a good position in an accountant's office in the City and voluntarily went out to fight for his country. He joined the Artists Rifles in March, 1915, and went to France the following August. He took active part in the many operations in which this Regiment distinguished itself, and subsequently received a commission, in August, 1916, in the Royal Berks. He was killed in action on October 13, 1917.



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DOUAI SOCIETY 1914-1918 ROLL OF HONOUR	
2nd Lt. Geoffrey Herbert Tigar d. 13 October 1917 (age 21) Royal Berkshire Regiment Geoffrey Tigar was born in Belgium in 1896. His brother Harold was an Old Dowegian who also fell. <i>Memorial: Tyne Cot</i>	2nd Lt. Geoffrey Herbert Tigar d. 13 October 1917 (age 21) Royal Berkshire Regiment Geoffrey Tigar was born in Belgium in 1896. His brother Harold was an Old Dowegian who also fell. <i>Memorial: Tyne Cot</i>

Anniversary Pupil research 2014	
Tigar, G H Died at Neuve-Chappelle, 13th October 1917 aged 21, only ten days after arrival.	Tigar, G H Died at Neuve-Chappelle, 15th October 1917 aged 21, only ten days after arrival.

Probate 1918 (FMP)	
TIGAR Geoffrey Herbert of 112 Nibthwaite-road Harrow Middlesex second-lieutenant 6th battalion Royal Berkshire regiment died 13 October 1917 in Flanders Administration London 5 April to Walter Tigar member of stock exchange. Effects £118 2s. 9d.	Probate 1918 (FMP) TIGAR Geoffrey Herbert of 112 Nibthwaite-road Harrow Middlesex second-lieutenant 6th battalion Royal Berkshire regiment died 13 October 1917 in Flanders Administration London 5 April to Walter Tigar member of stock exchange. Effects £118 2s. 9d.

War Pensions etc from FMP - £35 per annum

✓	1	Tigar	Mother Mary Agnes 112 Kilthwaite Rd, Harrow	2nd Lieut. Geoffrey Herbert Tigar 6 (Ser.) Bn Rl. Berks Rgt. & 2nd Lt Harold Walter Tigar, Spec List 3 Bn Midd. Sex Rgt.	£240	✓ 1918 2 May	1917 1 April 14 Oct	20 35	5 8	15	April . May . June . July . Aug. . Sept. Oct. . Nov. . Dec. . Jan. . Feb. . Marc
					19 Oct 1859						

Notes regarding the third brother who died during the War years:

Laurence Tigar

- died between Oct-Dec 1915 and his death was registered in the Hendon registration district. He was 20 which gives him a birth year of c1895.
- he is not listed on the CWGC website
- nor is he listed on the IWM war memorial database
- his younger brother Wilfred didn't die until 1966 age 65 so he didn't die in the war, and an older brother Frederick didn't die until 1954 (they were both in the war)
- 1911 census confirms that he was the younger brother of Frederick and Harold and older brother of Geoffrey & Wilfred
- No probate
- Younger brother Wilfred J died in 1966 aged 65 so he didn't die in war
- No obituaries in local newspapers
- Not listed in Find A Grave website

Based on the above we assume Laurence was the third brother to die during the war years, though not in battle.

- N.B. All researches seem to incorrectly link Laurence Tigar to Bertrand Benoit Tigar, the latter was the son of Edward Tigar, so not one of the brothers